

File 43: EOS Board Governance & Competitor Workflows Playbook

Advisory Board Governance & Operational Competitor Benchmarking Brand: Blue Ridge Stream Restoration & Mitigation LLC **Frameworks:** Gino Wickman's Traction (EOS) & Vern Harnish's Scaling Up **Supervising Board:** Hunter Morris (Co-Founder & Managing Director) & Hadi Irvani (Board Member)

1. Competitor Operational Workflows & Drone Benchmarking

To build a significant competitive advantage in Georgia, Hunter Morris must understand how corporate mitigation conglomerates structure their environmental workflows and project scales compared to traditional boutique civil contractors.

A. Operational Workflow Comparison

Operational Phase	Traditional Grading Contractors	PE-Backed Corporate Conglomerates (RES, EIP, Wildlands)	Blue Ridge Stream Restoration (Hunter's Venture)
1. Stream Assessment	Manual walking surveys with static measuring tapes and basic rod-readings. High margin of error in high-gradient reaches.	Expensive surveyor crews using terrestrial LiDAR scanners and Total Stations. High cost, slow mobilization (3-6 weeks).	RTK-assisted GPS terrain tagging combined with UAS (Unmanned Aerial System) aerial photogrammetry. High speed (1-2 days), sub-centimeter accuracy.
2. Stream Photography	Standard hand-held camera or mobile phone photography. Hard to document structural geometries or canopy coverage.	Periodic commercial flights or high-cost outsourced mapping services. Visual data remains locked in engineering silos.	High-frequency DJI RTK flight paths to build consistent orthomosaics, georeferenced 3D point clouds, and high-density terrain meshes.
3. Remote Sensing	None. Standard visual checks for bank erosion.	Satellite imagery (Landsat/Sentinel) analysis. Coarse resolution ($\$10\text{m/pixel}$), highly limited under heavy canopy cover.	Multispectral sensor drone mapping QGIS analysis. Generates $\$1.5\text{cm/pixel}$ NDVI (Normalized Difference Vegetation Index) arrays to prove vegetation growth.
4. Ideal Project Scale	Small local bank repairs ($\$100$ to $\$500$ linear feet). General grading, no regulatory credit generation.	Massive watershed tracts ($>5,000$ linear feet or >100 acres of wetlands). High mobilization threshold, uninterested in smaller high-yield sites.	Boutique high-yield reaches ($\$1,000$ to $\$3,000$ linear feet) of high-gradient trout meanders. Maximizes geomorphic credit yield factor ($\$8.6\text{credits/LF}$) via Priority 1 restoration.

B. Competitor Project Size & Scale Benchmarks

- **The Conglomerate Scale (RES & EIP):** These institutional funds target large-scale agricultural degradation sites yielding over $\$15,000$ credits. *They rarely bid on projects with under $\$5,000$ linear feet* because their overhead, mobilization costs, and corporate hierarchies require massive credit volumes to achieve their target internal rates of return (IRR).
- **The Boutique Local Scale:** Traditional excavators operate on small residential or agricultural bank repairs. They use heavy rock rip-rap and concrete, which are environmentally destructive and do not qualify for USACE Savannah District stream mitigation credits.
- **Blue Ridge's Sweet Spot ($\$1,000$ to $\$3,000$ LF):** Hunter's ideal project scale fits precisely in this gap. By targeting high-gradient, coldwater trout watersheds (e.g. Anderson Creek, Goldmine Hollow) on private estates and mountain cabins, he accesses lands that conglomerates ignore. Because these sites utilize natural geomorphic meanders (Priority 1 Natural Channel Design), they achieve a premium credit yield factor ($\$8.6\text{credits/LF}$), generating high financial returns with low overhead.

2. Expansion Targets for the Board of Advisors

To supplement the five primary board members proposed in **File 20** (Academic, Regulatory, Legal, Sales, and Civil Construction), Hunter should target five additional regional specialists to expand B2B land acquisition, data center buyers access, and conservation banking networks:

1. **Land Conservation Trust Director (Target: Executive Director, Georgia Highlands Land Trust)**

- *Strategic Purpose:* Sourcing off-market landowners. Land trusts are in constant contact with wealthy private owners of large mountain tracts. Having a land trust director on the board creates a warm referral funnel for joint-venture stream easements.

2. **Corporate ESG / Data Center Sustainability Lead (Target: VP of Sustainability, QTS Data Centers or Google GA Infrastructure)**

- *Strategic Purpose:* Direct PRM sales access. Hyperscalers have immediate, high-volume credit needs for their Georgia campuses. Direct board access allows Hunter to pitch Permittee-Responsible Mitigation (PRM) packages directly to buyers before they seek credits from third-party brokers.

3. **State Agricultural Extension Representative (Target: UGA Warnell School of Forestry & Natural Resources Outreach Lead)**

- *Strategic Purpose:* Building rural credibility. Agricultural landowners are naturally skeptical of corporate developers. A respected UGA Extension representative on the board validates Blue Ridge's ecological mission and helps source agricultural JV tracts.

4. **Heavy Equipment Rental & Logistics Partner (Target: Regional VP, Yancey Bros. Co. - Georgia Caterpillar Dealer)**

- *Strategic Purpose:* Capital conservation. Instream construction requires heavy machinery (GPS-guided excavators, low-ground-pressure haulers). A strategic relationship with a major equipment dealer secures favorable lease terms and priority fleet access, preserving cash flow.

5. **Water Rights & Riparian Boundary Specialist (Target: Senior Surveyor, Georgia Board of Professional Engineers & Land Surveyors)**

- *Strategic Purpose:* Risk mitigation. Defining the exact geomorphic thalweg and bankfull boundaries on high-gradient mountain creeks is legally complex. A senior land survey expert ensures all restrictive covenant drawings are bulletproof, preventing title challenges.

3. Bi-Monthly Board Meeting Calendar (June 2026 - April 2027)

To establish operational accountability and structure, Hunter Morris (Managing Director) and Hadi Irvani (Board Member) will implement a **bi-monthly board meeting cycle**. Meetings will occur on the **second Tuesday of every other month at 10:00 AM EST** (lasting exactly 90 minutes):

- **Session 1: June 9, 2026 (10:00 AM - 11:30 AM)**

- *Core Focus:* Phase 1 Launch Audit, Anderson Creek option agreement execution, and UGA/GT intern onboarding.

- **Session 2: August 11, 2026 (10:00 AM - 11:30 AM)**

- *Core Focus:* QGIS Drone Surveying orthomosaic reviews, draft PCN package finalization for USACE, and Q2 financial review.

- **Session 3: October 13, 2026 (10:00 AM - 11:30 AM)**
- *Core Focus:* USACE Savannah District IRT site audit preparation, data center direct sales pipeline review, and Q3 cash flow forecasts.
- **Session 4: December 8, 2026 (10:00 AM - 11:30 AM)**
- *Core Focus:* Fluvial bioengineering winter planting logistics (Rhododendron max geomorphic transplanting), tax planning, and CRM pipeline expansions.
- **Session 5: February 9, 2027 (10:00 AM - 11:30 AM)**
- *Core Focus:* Permitting progress audit, land bank sourcing database updates, and regional ag-bankers outreach review.
- **Session 6: April 13, 2027 (10:00 AM - 11:30 AM)**
- *Core Focus:* Annual construction plan finalization, spring vegetation survival audits, and Q1 financial review.

4. EOS "Level 10" Board Meeting Agenda

To maintain extreme focus and prevent meetings from devolving into unstructured storytelling, the Board of Advisors will follow the strict, time-blocked **Traction EOS "Level 10 Meeting" format** (90 minutes total):

EOS LEVEL 10 BOARD AGENDA (90 MIN)		
[10:00 - 10:05]	Segue & Good News (Personal & Professional Highlights)	
[10:05 - 10:15]	Scorecard Review (Review 5 Leading Operational Metrics)	
[10:15 - 10:25]	Rock Review (Status of 90-Day Critical Priorities)	
[10:25 - 10:30]	Headlines (Customer, Landowner & Employee News)	
[10:30 - 10:35]	To-Do List (Review of Action Items from Previous Session)	
[10:35 - 11:25]	IDS Session (Identify, Discuss, Solve Key Issues)	
[11:25 - 11:30]	Conclude & Meeting Rating (Target: 8+ out of 10 score)	

Agenda Breakdowns & Accountability Controls:

1. **Segue & Good News (5 mins):** Establishes a collaborative, positive environment. Each board member shares one win.
2. **Scorecard Review (10 mins):** Hunter reviews the 5 leading scorecard metrics. Any metric that is off-track is dropped straight down to the IDS list.
3. **Rock Review (10 mins):** Hunter reports "On Track" or "Off Track" for his three 90-day Rocks (strategic goals). No discussion is allowed here; off-track Rocks go to the IDS list.
4. **Headlines (5 mins):** Review landowner relations (e.g. Roya Irvani's Anderson Creek feedback) and USACE Savannah District communications.
5. **To-Do List (5 mins):** Rapid-fire check-off of 7-day action items. The board expects a 90% on-time completion rate.
6. **IDS Session (50 mins):** The core of the meeting. The board prioritizes the compiled issues list, identifies the root cause of the top 3 issues, discusses solutions, and assigns concrete to-do items. *Never move to Issue #4 until Issue #1 is completely resolved.*
7. **Conclude & Rating (5 mins):** Recaps the newly generated To-Do list, confirms any external messages to stakeholders, and has each member rate the meeting on a scale of 1-10 (focusing on efficiency).

5. Hunter's EOS & Scaling Up Business Integration Projects

To successfully apply Gino Wickman's **Traction** and Vern Harnish's **Scaling Up** (People, Strategy, Execution, Cash), Hunter must execute 4 structured business integration projects:

Project 1: The Vision/Traction Organizer (V/TO)

- **The Mandate:** Read *Traction* (Chapters 3 & 4) and draft the complete Blue Ridge V/TO.
- **Deliverables:**
 1. *Core Values:* Define the 3-5 core values (e.g., Fluvial Geomorphic Integrity, Landowner-First Partnership, Scientific Precision).
 2. *Core Focus:* Articulate our niche (Boutique, coldwater wild trout Natural Channel Design stream restoration in North Georgia).
 3. *10-Year Target:* Establish the BHAG (Big Hairy Audacious Goal) - e.g., \$100,000\$ linear feet of restored spawning streams.
 4. *3-Year Picture:* Outline revenues, credit yields, and operations scale.
 5. *1-Year Plan:* Target 3-5 high-priority goals (e.g., Anderson Creek permitting, securing 3 additional JV options, building the B2B direct sales pipeline).

Project 2: The Accountability Chart (People) Delineation

- **The Mandate:** Read *Traction* (Chapter 5) and *Scaling Up* (People section). Transition from a traditional "titles" mindset to a functional "seats" accountability chart.
- **Deliverables:**
 1. *Identify Core Seats:* Define the five key seats for Blue Ridge: **Visionary** (Hadi Irvani - Strategy & Finance), **Integrator/Managing Director** (Hunter Morris - Daily Operations), **Marketing & Sales** (CRM pipeline, broker outreach), **Operations** (Drone surveying, instream grading, intern oversight), and **Finance/Legal** (QuickBooks, escrow accounts, restrictive covenants).
 2. *Write GWC Roles:* Define the 5 primary responsibilities for each seat, and ensure the assigned person **Gets it, Wants it**, and has the **Capacity** to do it.

Project 3: Weekly L10 Scorecard Setup (Process & Execution)

- **The Mandate:** Read *Traction* (Chapter 7) and *Scaling Up* (Execution section). Create a weekly scorecard to monitor leading indicator metrics.
- **Scorecard Structure:**

Metric Name	Seat Accountable	Target Threshold	Type of Metric
Sourced Landowners	Sales / Marketing	lge 5 new contacts / week	Leading Indicator
Active JV Options	Sales / Integrator	lge 2 in negotiation	Leading Indicator
Drone Surveys Run	Operations	lge 1 complete / bi-weekly	Operational Activity
PCN Filings Completed	Operations / Permitting	On target for 90-day timeline	Milestones

Metric Name	Seat Accountable	Target Threshold	Type of Metric
Escrow Cash Balance	Finance	≥ 6 months operational runway	Trailing Financial

Project 4: The 70/30 JV Cash Flow & Runway Stress-Test (Cash)

- **The Mandate:** Read *Scaling Up* (Cash section) and analyze our joint-venture cash cycles to prevent working capital exhaustion.
- **Analysis Directives:**
 1. *Map the Cash Flow Story:* Detail the cash outlays during the pre-construction phase (permitting, engineering, drone mapping, land option renewals) before the first \$15\%\$ credit release.
 2. *Stress-Test Delayed Milestones:* Calculate the financial runway if the USACE Savannah District delayed the initial credit release by **6 months** or **12 months** due to administrative backlogs.
 3. *Establish Cash Reserves:* Model a permanent cash reserve account inside QuickBooks, funded by a dedicated \$10\%\$ withhold of initial credit sales, to cover the 7-year monitoring and vegetation management obligations without relying on external financing.